DRILL 06

HOSE & STREAMS

NFPA 1001 Level 1 (JPR 4.3.7, 4.3.10) / WorkSafeNB Reg 91-191

ATTACK LINE DEPLOYMENT & FLAKING (CROSSLAY / MINUTEMAN)

⏱ **Time:** 45–60 min | 🚒 **Apparatus:** Pumper / Engine | 🦺 **PPE:** Full Structural Turnout Gear & Gloves

👥 **Roles:** Drill Leader (Facilitator) | Safety Officer (Watcher) | Nozzleman & Backup Firefighter

🎯 OBJECTIVE & RURAL FIREGROUND VALUE

Every firefighter must be able to rapidly deploy a 200-ft (60m) 1.75" (45mm) preconnected attack line from the apparatus crosslay or rear bed, stretch it to the entrance doorway, flake out the 50-ft working length without kinks, call for water, and bleed air from the nozzle before entering. A clean stretch guarantees maximum water flow without pressure-robbing spaghetti kinks.

📦 TOOLS & APPARATUS SETUP

- Apparatus equipped with 1.75" (45mm) preconnects (Minuteman, Crosslay, or Triple-Layer load).
- Attack nozzle (combination fog or smooth bore).
- Cones or simulated structure entrance doorway 100–150 feet away from the apparatus.
- Pump operator or member staged at pump panel to charge the line.

⚠️ SAFETY WATCH-OUTS & STOP RULE

⚠️ **Tripping Hazards:** Watch for firefighters tripping backward over hose folds during the stretch.

⚠️ **Kink Check:** When line charges, inspect full length for sharp 90-degree kinks (each severe kink cuts water flow by up to 30%).

⚠️ **Nozzle Reaction:** Ensure the nozzle firefighter has a firm two-handed grip with bail closed before calling for water.

🛑 **THE STOP RULE: Shout "STOP!" immediately if the hose violently kinks, whips, or knocks a member off balance while charging.**

PHASE 1: WALKTHROUGH OF LOAD & DEPLOYMENT MECHANICS (15 MINUTES) — SLOW DRY RUN

1. **Understand the Load (Minuteman / Crosslay):**
   - Review how your department's hose bed is packed.
   - Identify the **nozzle loop** (working length) and the **pull loop(s)** (drag load).
2. **The 3 Rules of Hose Deployment:**
   - **Rule 1:** Take your time on the pull; speed comes from clean deployment, not running.
   - **Rule 2:** The nozzle and working length (last 50 ft) MUST reach the threshold of the entry door before the line is charged.
   - **Rule 3:** Flake the working length in large, loose loops parallel to the building or back down the driveway—never dump a pile of hose directly on the front porch.

DRILL 06: PRACTICAL EVOLUTIONS & TAILGATE DEBRIEF

Hose & Streams • Practical Application

PHASE 2: DEPLOYMENT & FLAKING REPETITIONS (20 MINUTES) — BUDDY COACHING

1. **Execution Steps:**
   - **Step 1 (The Pull):** Step up to the crosslay/rear bed. Grasp the nozzle and nozzle loop with your dominant hand. Grasp the second pull loop with your off-hand.
   - **Step 2 (The Stretch):** Pull all hose clear of the bed. Place the nozzle load onto your shoulder. Turn and walk toward the designated entry door.
   - **Step 3 (Dropping the Drag):** When the drag load runs tight (~75–100 ft out), drop the secondary loops from your hand. Continue walking with the shoulder load to the door.
   - **Step 4 (Flaking the Working Length):** Stop 10–15 feet from the door. Lay the nozzle down gently. Walk the remaining loops toward the open driveway or yard, flaking the hose in an "S" or "U" pattern free of twists.
2. **Calling for Water & Bleeding the Line:**
   - Nozzleman picks up nozzle, sits/anchors the line behind their hip, and calls via radio: *"Engine 1, charge the 1.75 crosslay!"*
   - As water arrives, watch the line stiffen. Shake out any minor kinks.
   - Point nozzle upward at a 45-degree angle. Open the bail slowly to bleed trapped air until a solid, unbroken stream flows.
   - Check nozzle pattern (straight stream vs narrow fog) and close bail smoothly.

PHASE 3: TIMED CREW STRETCH (15 MINUTES) — TIMED / STRESS

1. Team of 2 (Nozzleman & Backup Firefighter) start seated in the cab or at the tailboard.
2. On call: *"Deploy attack line to Side Alpha front door!"*
3. Deploy, stretch, flake, charge, bleed air, and announce *"Line charged and ready for entry!"* Target time: **under 90 seconds**.
4. Reverse roles and repeat with alternate hose loads.

⚠️ COMMON PITFALLS & FIREGROUND HAZARDS

- ❌ *Charging the line in the hose bed:* Never call for water while hose is still packed in the tray—it expands and locks itself into the bed!
- ❌ *Dropping the nozzle short of the door:* If the nozzle drops 50 feet from the door, you must drag 200 lbs of water-filled hose just to reach the threshold.
- ❌ *Failing to bleed air before entering:* Trapped air causes violent nozzle sputtering and momentary water loss during an interior attack.

🗣️ 5-MINUTE TAILGATE DEBRIEF

1. ***"Did the working length flake cleanly without twisting?", "How many kinks did the safety officer find in the lay?"***

✅ APPARATUS RESET CHECKLIST

- [ ] Line drained: Disconnect nozzle, open bleeder, walk hose from fold to coupling to push out all water.
- [ ] Couplings inspected for dirt/grit in threads and intact rubber gaskets.
- [ ] Hose repacked carefully to department standard (Minuteman / Crosslay) with pull loops properly spaced.
- [ ] Nozzle attached, bail shut, gallonage set.
- [ ] Attendance roster signed.

DRILL LEADER SIGNATURE	SAFETY OFFICER SIGNATURE	DATE COMPLETED	TRAINING HOURS